



TIPS & TRICKS



Creating a user account with a random password using the shell script

Here is a simple shell script to create users in Linux with a random password. This uses *apg* to generate a password. If the package *apg* is not installed, install it by running the following command before running the script:

```
sudo apt-get install apg
```

Now create a file with the following script:

```
#!/bin/sh

echo -n "Enter the user account name(say exam) : "

read name

echo -n "Enter the start and end range of this account(say
1 20) : "
read start end
for ((i=$start;i<=$end;i++))
do

    /usr/sbin/useradd $name$i

    pass=`apg -a 1 -n 1 -m5 -x 8`

    echo -e "\t"$name$i"\t"$pass >> pass.log

    echo $name$i:$pass|chpasswd
done
```

After running the script, the newly generated password will be stored in the *pass.log* file.



Note: *apg* or Automated Password Generator is used for generating random passwords. Read the *apg* man page for details.

—Benedict Nicholas,
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Turning off the log-in message

If you connect to a Linux machine (e.g., Ubuntu) from another machine via *ssh*, you would have noticed that it prints information or a series of messages before presenting the command prompt.

Although such information can be useful, it gets annoying if you connect very often.

You can turn these messages off by running the following simple command:

```
touch ~/.hushlogin
```

From the next time, you will be directly presented with the prompt!

If you want to get the messages back, simply delete the *.hushlogin* file.

—Urmil Parikh,
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View the ASCII conversion chart

We often need to find out the ASCII values of characters. So, here is a simple tip that will print the conversion chart:

```
[bash]$ man ascii.
```

The above command will show the manual pages with the ASCII character set encoded in octal, decimal and hexadecimal format.

—Narendra Kangralkar,
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How to list the total files, links and directories in the current folder

In order to list all the files, links and directories in the current folder recursively, use the following commands:

```
for t in files links directories;
```

```
do echo `find . -type ${t:0:1} | wc -l` $t; done 2> /dev/null
```